



A MÆD PARTNERS TOOL · HIGHER EDUCATION

# Validation Readiness Checklist

*A structured, sector-agnostic tool for programme teams preparing a new or revalidated programme for academic validation in UK higher education — aligned to the QAA Quality Code, FHEQ, and OfS conditions of registration.*

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## AUDIENCE

**Programme leaders · module leads ·  
quality teams**

## USE AT

**Pre-validation — 8 to 12 weeks before  
panel**

## VERSION

**1.0 · April 2026**

## 00 Purpose & how to use

*Validation is the most demanding quality-assurance gateway in the life of a UK higher education programme. This checklist is designed to help programme teams arrive at the panel confident, evidenced, and internally consistent.*

The checklist covers the thirteen domains that a typical validation panel — internal or external, academic or professional body — will probe. It is deliberately generic: the items reflect expectations common to almost every UK provider and, with minor adaptation, to providers regulated in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland. It is not a substitute for your institution's own validation handbook; it is a companion to it.

### When to use it

Begin at the point of business-case sign-off.  
Work through it iteratively — first as a gap analysis, then as a readiness tracker in the eight weeks before panel.

### How to score it

Rate each item against the RAG key below. A programme is *panel-ready* only when every item is Green or carries an agreed mitigation note.

### Who should complete it

The programme leader owns it. Module leads, the quality office, library, and student support contribute to specific domains. The Head of Department or equivalent signs off.

### Evidence discipline

For every Green rating, name the evidence artefact and its location. "We've thought about it" is not evidence. Panels reward traceability.

## RAG status key

### Green

Complete, evidenced, panel-ready.

### Amber

In progress or partially evidenced.

### Red

Gap, blocker, or decision outstanding.

### N/A

Not applicable to this programme.

## Reference framework

Items in this checklist are cross-referenced against the QAA UK Quality Code for Higher Education (Core & Common Practices), the Framework for Higher Education Qualifications (FHEQ), the Office for Students (OfS) conditions of registration, relevant Subject Benchmark Statements, and — where applicable — Professional, Statutory and Regulatory Body (PSRB) requirements and the Competition & Markets Authority (CMA) higher education consumer guidance.

## 01 Strategic rationale & market positioning

Why should this programme exist, and why now? Panels expect a defensible answer grounded in mission, market, and money — not enthusiasm alone.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                           | STATUS                                                       | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Strategic fit articulated</b><br><i>Alignment to institutional strategy, school plan and portfolio shape demonstrated.</i>                         | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Market demand evidenced</b><br><i>UCAS/HESA trend data, labour-market intelligence, employer signal, competitor scan.</i>                          | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Target learner profile defined</b><br><i>Age, prior attainment, mode of study, UK/EU/international split, widening-participation contribution.</i> | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Financial viability modelled</b><br><i>Break-even point, contribution margin, capital and staffing cost, sensitivity analysis.</i>                 | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Portfolio cannibalisation risk assessed</b><br><i>Overlap with adjacent programmes, internal demand displacement quantified.</i>                   | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Distinctive value proposition articulated</b><br><i>What the programme offers that the sector does not already deliver well.</i>                   | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

## 02 Academic standards & programme design

The standards spine. Panels trace every claim back to FHEQ descriptors and Subject Benchmark Statements — if the thread breaks, confidence collapses.

| ITEM                                                                                                                             | STATUS                                                       | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Programme aims clearly stated</b><br><i>Concise, distinctive, aligned to FHEQ level descriptors.</i> | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                                                 | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Programme learning outcomes (PLOs) fit-for-purpose</b><br><i>Measurable, level-appropriate, balanced across knowledge, skills, application, professional attributes.</i> |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Subject Benchmark Statement mapped</b><br><i>PLOs cross-referenced to the relevant QAA benchmark; any omissions justified.</i>                                           |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Graduate attributes articulated and embedded</b><br><i>Institutional attributes identifiable in programme and module outcomes, not only rhetoric.</i>                    |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>PSRB requirements mapped</b><br><i>Professional body competencies covered; accreditation pathway scoped.</i>                                                             |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Credit volume and level distribution</b><br><i>Credits per level correct; ECTS equivalence stated; double-counting avoided.</i>                                          |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Comparator benchmarking completed</b><br><i>Three or more comparator programmes analysed for scope, level, and signature features.</i>                                   |        | .....               | ..... |

### 03 Curriculum & module architecture

The structure that turns outcomes into a journey. Test it by tracing a student through it from induction to award.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                    | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Core / optional structure rationalised</b><br><i>Core coverage guarantees PLO achievement; optional choice is meaningful, not cosmetic.</i> |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Progression logic evidenced</b><br><i>Demand and support increase across levels; pre/co-requisites are coherent.</i>                        |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>PLO-to-module mapping matrix supplied</b><br><i>Every PLO is taught, practised and assessed — in at least one module each.</i>              |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Research–teaching nexus visible</b><br><i>Students encounter current scholarship, not just canonical content.</i>                           |        | .....               | ..... |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                                           | STATUS                                                             | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <div><input type="checkbox"/> <b>Interim awards defined</b><br/><i>Exit awards carry coherent outcomes — not arbitrary subsets of the full programme.</i></div>                                | <div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <div><input type="checkbox"/> <b>Decolonised / inclusive curriculum review completed</b><br/><i>Reading lists, case studies and examples audited for representation and perspective.</i></div> | <div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

## 04 Learning, teaching & assessment strategy

*Pedagogy is the programme's heartbeat. A coherent, evidence-informed strategy that matches outcomes, students, and resources is non-negotiable.*

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                   | STATUS                                                       | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Pedagogic approach articulated</b><br><i>Teaching philosophy stated and grounded in scholarship, not generic jargon.</i>                   | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Mode of delivery justified</b><br><i>Face-to-face, blended or online rationale matches learner profile and outcomes.</i>                   | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Formative / summative balance</b><br><i>Formative tasks precede every summative; feedback loops are designed in.</i>                       | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Assessment load audited</b><br><i>Volume and timing mapped across semesters; bunching, duplication, and gaps addressed.</i>                | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Authentic assessment integrated</b><br><i>Tasks mirror professional practice where meaningful; not authentic for its own sake.</i>         | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Inclusive assessment principles applied</b><br><i>Flexibility, accessibility, reasonable adjustments, and EDI implications considered.</i> | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Academic integrity &amp; generative AI position</b><br><i>Clear stance on permitted AI use per assessment; integrity mechanisms named.</i> | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Feedback principles and turnaround</b><br><i>Commitment to timing and quality of feedback stated and realistic at scale.</i>               | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

## 05 Student experience & support

*A programme is a service, not only a syllabus. Panels are alert to the difference.*

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                        | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Induction &amp; transition plan</b><br><i>Structured, inclusive induction covering academic, social and wellbeing dimensions.</i>               |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Personal tutoring model</b><br><i>Named model, contact frequency, training and caseload workable.</i>                                           |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Academic skills &amp; employability support</b><br><i>Embedded, not bolt-on; maps to level and to graduate attributes.</i>                      |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Wellbeing &amp; disability support pathways</b><br><i>Referral routes, reasonable adjustments, and inclusive practice signposted.</i>           |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Student voice mechanisms</b><br><i>Course representatives, SSLC, module evaluation, closing-the-loop.</i>                                       |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Complaints, appeals, integrity procedures linked</b><br><i>Signposted in handbook and induction; consistent with institutional regulations.</i> |        | .....               | ..... |

## 06 Staffing, expertise & scholarship

Programmes are only as strong as the people who run them. Panels will probe capability, capacity and continuity.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                   | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Core teaching team identified</b><br><i>Named staff, CVs annexed, allocations transparent.</i>                                             |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Staff : student ratio modelled at steady state</b><br><i>Ratios sustainable at full recruitment, not only cohort one.</i>                  |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Research-active &amp; professional expertise balance</b><br><i>Scholarship visible; practitioner insight where the subject demands it.</i> |        | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>CPD plan for new demands</b><br><i>Upskilling for new pedagogies, technologies, PSRB updates.</i>                                          |        | .....               | ..... |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                            | STATUS                                                             | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <div><input type="checkbox"/> <b>Succession and contingency</b><br/><i>Key-person risk acknowledged; cover for programme leader and critical modules.</i></div> | <div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <div><input type="checkbox"/> <b>External examiner profile matched</b><br/><i>Subject fit, independence, and standing; nomination pack prepared.</i></div>      | <div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |



## 07 Resources, environment & infrastructure

*Spaces, systems and stock. Panels will ask whether the programme can actually run on day one — and in year three.*

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                               | STATUS                                                                              | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Physical learning spaces audited</b><br><i>Rooms, labs and specialist environments appropriate in type, capacity and availability.</i> |    |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Library resources reviewed</b><br><i>Core texts available, e-resources licensed, gap list procured or costed.</i>                      |    |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Digital infrastructure confirmed</b><br><i>VLE, e-assessment, plagiarism, specialist software, accessibility tools.</i>                |    |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Placement / work-integrated learning</b><br><i>Partner network, due diligence, placement agreements, visiting tutor capacity.</i>      |    |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Accessibility of environment verified</b><br><i>Physical and digital environments meet statutory and best-practice expectations.</i>   |  |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Sustainability considerations documented</b><br><i>Content integration and operational footprint of the programme acknowledged.</i>    |  |                     |       |

## 08 Equality, diversity & inclusion

*Access, participation, attainment and outcomes. A strong programme closes gaps; it does not merely acknowledge them.*

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                   | STATUS                                                                              | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>EDI impact assessment completed</b><br><i>Design choices interrogated for disproportionate impact on protected groups.</i> |  |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Inclusive curriculum audit evidenced</b><br><i>Content, voices, case studies and examples reviewed for representation.</i> |  |                     |       |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                             | STATUS                                                  | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Access &amp; Participation Plan contribution</b><br><i>Alignment to OfS APP targets explicit, not assumed.</i>                       | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Differential attainment risks addressed</b><br><i>Evidence-based mitigations for known attainment gaps in the discipline.</i>        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Devolved-nation considerations</b><br><i>Welsh language, Gaelic, or Northern Ireland-specific duties addressed where applicable.</i> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |

## 09 External engagement & stakeholder input

*Programmes designed in a closed room fail in the open market. Show the windows and doors.*

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                          | STATUS                                                  | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Employer / industry advisory input</b><br><i>Meaningful consultation documented; influence on design visible, not decorative.</i> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Alumni consultation</b><br><i>Graduate perspectives integrated where the programme has predecessors.</i>                          | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>External academic peer review</b><br><i>Critical-friend review before panel; response log maintained.</i>                         | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Student co-design activity</b><br><i>Current students involved in design; contributions documented.</i>                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>PSRB pre-validation engagement</b><br><i>Professional body consulted early; accreditation pathway confirmed.</i>                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |

## 10 Quality assurance & enhancement

Validation is not the end of oversight — it is the beginning. Panels want to see the loop, not only the launch.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                   | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Annual monitoring framework mapped</b><br><i>Data sources, committees and reporting rhythm identified.</i>                 |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Periodic review cycle positioned</b><br><i>Next review scheduled; programme positioned within the institutional cycle.</i> |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>External examiner nomination ready</b><br><i>Paperwork complete; independence and subject fit defensible.</i>              |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Module &amp; programme evaluation mechanisms</b><br><i>Instruments, rhythm and closing-the-loop practice defined.</i>      |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>NSS / PTES response pathway</b><br><i>Mechanism for acting on sector survey data identified.</i>                           |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Enhancement plan outlined</b><br><i>Initial enhancement priorities flagged — not left to year-one panic.</i>               |        |                     |       |

## 11 Regulatory & compliance

The non-negotiable layer. These items rarely win a panel but they can certainly lose one.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                               | STATUS | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>OfS conditions of registration considered</b><br><i>Quality (B1–B5), Student Outcomes (B3), and Consumer Protection (C1–C3) implications reviewed.</i> |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>UKVI compliance verified</b><br><i>Student sponsor duties, attendance monitoring and reporting — if recruiting internationally.</i>                    |        |                     |       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>CMA consumer protection</b><br><i>Pre-contract information, material change rules and complaints routes aligned.</i>                                   |        |                     |       |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                         | STATUS                                                  | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Prevent duty considerations</b><br><i>Content, pedagogy and placements reviewed; staff briefed where relevant.</i>               | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Data protection (UK GDPR)</b><br><i>Teaching, assessment and placement data flows documented.</i>                                | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Collaborative provision due diligence</b><br><i>Partner arrangements, responsibilities and risk assessed – where applicable.</i> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |

## 12 Documentation readiness

What the panel actually sees. An immaculate documentation set is a credibility multiplier.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                           | STATUS                                                  | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Programme specification complete</b><br><i>In-house template, proofread, internally approved.</i>                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Module specifications complete</b><br><i>Every module – core and optional – with full outcome, content, and assessment detail.</i> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Outcome mapping matrices</b><br><i>FHEQ, Subject Benchmark, graduate attributes, PSRB as applicable.</i>                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Staff CVs and allocations annexed</b><br><i>Aligned to teaching plan; no unnamed "TBC" against delivery.</i>                       | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Resource gap analysis and commitments</b><br><i>What is missing, what is being procured, who has funded it.</i>                    | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Market research and financial model</b><br><i>Attached as appendices, not summarised by rumour.</i>                                | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Student handbook (draft)</b><br><i>Adapted template or fresh draft ready for cohort one.</i>                                       | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | .....               | ..... |

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                                | STATUS                                                  | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <div><input type="checkbox"/></div> <div><b>Response document to prior peer review</b><br/><i>Every substantive comment from critical-friend review addressed in writing.</i></div> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <div><input type="checkbox"/></div> <div><b>Equality impact assessment annexed</b><br/><i>Not the last page to be written.</i></div>                                                | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <div><input type="checkbox"/></div> <div><b>Document index and cross-references</b><br/><i>Hyperlinked, searchable, version-controlled.</i></div>                                   | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

# 13 Panel day & post-panel readiness

The performance layer. Preparation turns a credible design into a successful outcome.

| ITEM                                                                                                                                                                          | STATUS                                                       | EVIDENCE / LOCATION | OWNER       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Chair's briefing scheduled</b><br><i>Panel chair briefed on programme, risks, and areas of judgement.</i>                                         | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Proposer team briefed on protocols</b><br><i>Who answers what; how to handle disagreement; how to accept conditions gracefully.</i>               | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Anticipated challenges rehearsed</b><br><i>Top ten likely questions and response positions agreed; red-team review complete.</i>                  | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Student voice on the day</b><br><i>Current student available to meet panel (for revalidation) or authentic engagement evidenced.</i>              | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Condition &amp; recommendation response plan</b><br><i>Named owner, tracking log, target closure dates.</i>                                       | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <b>Commencement dependencies tracked</b><br><i>Marketing, admissions codes, timetabling and enrolment dependencies on validation outcome logged.</i> | <div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> </div> | <div></div>         | <div></div> |

## Readiness sign-off

The programme team confirms that every domain in this checklist has been completed, reviewed, and where Red or Amber, carries an agreed mitigation note. The programme is judged *ready* to proceed to validation panel.

Programme Leader

Head of Department / School

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Name, signature, date

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Name, signature, date

Quality lead

External peer reviewer

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Name, signature, date

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Name, signature, date

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**About this tool.** The Validation Readiness Checklist is published by mæd partners as a sector-agnostic instrument for UK higher education providers. It is designed for use alongside — not instead of — the host institution's validation handbook and quality framework. Feedback and adaptation for specific institutional contexts is welcomed.

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partners

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